



BASEBALL INSIDER

With Jim Ingraham, B8

MORNING JOURNAL SPORTS

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Gansey takes over

Bulldogs cruise past Shoremen in district final

By THERESA NEUHOFF
Morning Journal Writer

LORAIN — For one quarter, Mike Gansey barely made a peep for Olmsted Falls.

The Bulldogs' 6-foot-4 senior forward didn't score in the first quarter, but he scored plenty in the final three quarters to make up for it. He finished with a game-high 30 points and team-high 10 rebounds, leading the 'Dogs to a 64-47 Division II district championship victory over Avon Lake last night at Admiral King High School.

"My shot wasn't falling in the first quarter because their zone rattled us," said Gansey, while clutching a piece of net he cut from the basket following the win. "But finally things started working out for us and my teammates got me the ball so I could score."

The Shoremen, who finished their season 20-4 and 12-2 in the Southwestern Conference, had their last

lead of the contest in the second quarter. After a jumper inside by Tom Port, Avon Lake led 24-21 with 3:30 left in the first half.

But Gansey, who is continuing his basketball career on a full scholarship at Division I St. Bonaventure, closed the second with a steal and layin followed by a putback as time expired.

His back-to-back field goals gave the Bulldogs (19-4 and SWC winners at 13-1) a 25-24 lead at intermission which they did not relinquish. In the

See **GANSEY**, page B4



The Avon Lake team sits dejected after losing to Olmsted Falls last night in a Division II district final at Lorain Admiral King High School. Pictured left to right are: Brian Day, Brian Ingleright, Justin Booher and Rob Curry. For all the local results, check page B4.

MORNING JOURNAL/
JIM BOBEL

MAC TOURNEY

Huffman propels Kent St. to dance

Win clinches berth in NCAA tourney

By DAVID GLASIER
Morning Journal Writer

CLEVELAND — Three years ago, Kent State coach Gary Waters wasn't keen on the idea of giving a scholarship to Trevor Huffman, a spindly, 6-foot-1 kid from a little-known Michigan high school who was torching Andrew Mitchell and other Kent players in open gym.

Waters wanted to sign another big man, but Mitchell and his teammates wouldn't relent. They didn't want the kid going to a community college in Flint, Mich. They wanted him at Kent. Waters gave in. What he didn't know then, but certainly knows now, is the day he gave that scholarship to Huffman he got a big man.

Huffman, now a junior and Kent's unquestioned floor general, poured in a game-high 27 points yesterday as the Golden Flashes outlasted Miami University, 67-61, in the Mid-American Conference men's tournament championship at Gund Arena last night.

With a MAC tournament-record crowd 12,172 looking on, Huffman put his team on his back and carried them to victory and an automatic berth in the NCAA Tournament. Huffman was a freshman and a reserve when the Golden Flashes went to the NCAA Tournament two years ago. He played, but didn't make much of a splash.

Yesterday, Huffman generat-

See **FLASHES**, page B7

Lesson learned



Becky Kay, center, of Keystone is surrounded by Karyn Creager, left, and Lyndey Zgela of Patrick Henry as they go after a loose ball.

Patrick Henry takes Wildcats to school

By JASON LLOYD
Morning Journal Writer

LEXINGTON — After all that went right this year for Keystone, yesterday it all went terribly wrong.

Shut out in the first quarter. Eleven missed shots to open the game. More turnovers than points.

The Wildcats' season came to a crashing halt with a 43-15 loss to Patrick Henry in the Division III regional finals yesterday. But Keystone still finishes the sea-

son 21-4, far surpassing any and all expectations.

"I'm just as proud of this team as I was before the game," Keystone coach Scott Terry said. "This is a great bunch of girls and we found out today what that next level is all about."



Girls Hoops
Patrick Henry 43
Keystone 15

Patrick Henry came out in a triangle-and-two defense, swarming over point guard Brandy Terry and forcing other players to handle the ball.

The plan worked perfectly for the Patriots, who forced three turnovers in the game's first minute and eventually built a 15-0 lead at the end of the first quarter.

"We did not expect the triangle-and-two," Terry said. "That was something we

See **LESSON**, page B4



HAL
LEBOVITZ

Umps to limit batters' armor

A little bit of this and a little bit of that ...

HANGING IN: In addition to the higher strike zone and the crackdown on head-hunting pitchers, Major League Baseball has issued a new directive limiting the "armor" a batter can wear when he comes to the plate. From now on if a batter steps into the box wearing elbow protection — which became common last season — or shoulder pads or a bulletproof vest inside his jersey he must show the umpire a doctor's permit stating the equipment is necessary because the batter has an injury or bruise that requires protection.

It's like a note a mother will give a child to take to the teacher allowing special treatment.

The reason for the directive: Since the umpires have been ordered to crack down on pitchers throwing "chin music" they don't want it encouraged by batters hanging over the plate. Batters who do so invite the high-and-tight pitch and then the retaliatory stuff begins.

Furthermore the use of armor had been increasing to the point where the players'

See **HAL**, page B3

Indians feast on Lima in Venezuela

Thome, Branyan, Gonzo all go deep in 7-6 win

VALENCIA, Venezuela (AP) — Jose Lima struggled again last night, giving up three homers and six hits in four innings as the Cleveland Indians beat the Houston Astros 7-6.

Lima, who gave up 48 home

runs last season, allowed a two-run homer by Jim Thome in the first inning. Russell Branyan connected in the second, and Juan Gonzalez in the third to make it 5-1.

Lima gave up another run in the first inning on a wild pitch.

Spring Training



Glen Barker drove in Lance Berkman with a sacrifice fly in the eighth to give the Astros their only lead at 6-5. Houston pinch-hitter Carlos Maldonado tied it 5-all with a sacrifice fly earlier in the inning.

But Cleveland's Karim Garcia

answered with an RBI triple in the top of the ninth, and Terrell Lowery drove in Garcia with a double to make it 7-6.

Martin Vargas pitched a scoreless ninth for the save.

Cleveland starter Steve Woodard worked three innings, striking out three. He allowed one hit and Richard Hidalgo's sacrifice fly.



Indians players Omar Vizquel, left, and Roberto Alomar smile during batting practice at the Jose Bernardo Perez stadium in Valencia, Venezuela yesterday. The Indians beat the Astros 7-6 last night.

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